

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: A Student Exchange



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's backgrounds in a wider variety of communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Why would someone go on a student exchange?
- If you could go on exchange, where would you go? What would you study?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about manners and customs.
- I can write about things that I'm supposed to do and things that are supposed to happen.
- I can write about my attitudes toward an action.





Let's Explore!

Jessica is planning to study abroad. She asks a family friend to share his experiences. It's a little **nerve-racking***.

* "Nerve-racking" means to cause stress or anxiety.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Jessica:** Thanks for meeting me.
Justin: Not a problem.
Jessica: My cousin said that you worked in Colombia as an English teacher a couple years ago. I'm going as part of a student exchange program.
Justin: Is that through Boston College?
Jessica: Yes. Completing a degree in business administration in Colombia should open up a lot of doors and hopefully ... improve my Spanish.
Justin: Sounds like a great opportunity. Are you living with a host family?
Jessica: That's the plan. However, I'm supposed to be excited but I'm quite nervous.
Justin: Why?
Jessica: I know very little about the country.
Justin: Well, expect a warm welcome. You will soon be part of the family. Colombians value their families and relationships with friends. You definitely won't feel like a stranger!
Jessica: That's good to know.
Justin: Colombians like to share their rich history of ethnic diversity. From food and clothing to music and dance, customs have been shaped by the Spanish, Caribbean and African influences brought in by outside settlers.
Jessica: It will be nice to compare the differences in customs.
Justin: Partaking in some of the festivals and carnivals throughout the year is important. I went to Carnaval de Feria de las Flores while I was there. The flower shows in Medellin were spectacular.
Jessica: Cool.
Justin: Colombians also like to go to parks, movies, discos, and friends' houses in their free time. Music and dancing are an integral part of the culture.
Jessica: Sounds just like me. I tend to see myself as a bit of a socialite.
Justin: One thing I found interesting was their interest in American television.
Jessica: Really? I might not feel so homesick.
Justin: Yeah, they love their sitcoms. I should head off. I'm on a 15 minute break.
Jessica: Yes, I'm supposed to be in class. Thanks for the info.





Let's Practice!

Jessica learns about Colombian culture.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Find the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

dancing / Completing / to compare / study / to see / to go / Partaking / to share

1. Jessica is planning to _____ abroad.
2. _____ in some of the festivals and carnivals throughout the year is important.
3. I tend _____ myself as a bit of a socialite.
4. Colombians also like _____ to parks, movies, discos, and friends' houses in their free time.
5. Music and _____ are an integral part of the culture.
6. It will be nice _____ the differences between customs.
7. Colombians like _____ their rich history of ethnic diversity.
8. _____ a degree in business administration in Colombia is a great idea.



Let's Practice!

What are Jessica and Justin supposed to be doing?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Put each word in the correct order. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. but / quite / nervous / I'm / . / supposed / to / excited / I'm / be

2. head / should / . / off / I

3. I'm / to / be / . / now / class / supposed / in / right

4. I / a / studying / Colombia / while / in / . / write / I'm / should / blog



Extension Activity

How much do you know about the manners and cultures of other countries?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online.
- Choose a country that you would like to learn more about.
- Research the manners and customs of that country.
- Write 2 paragraphs about what you read. Include topic sentences, supporting sentences and concluding sentences.
- Include at least 1 gerund and 1 infinitive in each paragraph.
- Proofread your work.
- Read your paragraphs aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I choose a country to learn about.

☐ ☐

I research the manners and customs of a country.

☐ ☐

I write 2 paragraphs about manners and customs.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **exchange program** (noun): a study abroad program at one of their institution's partner institutions
e.g. I'm going as part of a student exchange program.
- **open up doors** (expression): when opportunities become available to someone
e.g. The experience should open up a lot of doors.
- **integral** (adjective): very important and necessary
e.g. Music and dancing are an integral part of the culture.
- **socialite** (noun): a person who is often seen at parties and other social events
e.g. I tend to see myself as a bit of a socialite.
- **homesick** (noun): sad because you are away from your family and home
e.g. I might not feel so homesick.
- **sitcom** (noun): a show that is on television regularly that is about a group of characters
e.g. They love their sitcoms.
- **to partake** (verb): to join with others in doing something
e.g. I would like to partake in the festival activities.





Learning Points

Gerunds and Infinitives

Gerunds and infinitives can sometimes be called verb complements. They may act as subjects or objects in a sentence.

A gerund is the -ing form of a verb that acts as a noun. The noun refers to an activity instead of a person or thing. You can use a gerund as the subject, the complement, or the object of a sentence.

Examples:

Subject of sentence:

Reading helps your comprehension and vocabulary.

Complement of sentence:

Justin's favorite pastime is **reading**.

Object of sentence

He enjoys **reading**.

An infinitive is a verb form that acts as a noun. It is formed with to + base form of the verb.

Example: *to talk, to enjoy, to play*

You cannot add We've **s**, We've **es**, We've **ed**, or We've **ing** to the end. It is not a verb.

Examples:

- **Dancing** is a central part of Colombian culture, whether this is done at a family home or in a busy nightclub.
- Many Colombians like **to boast** about their food, weather and music.





Learning Points

Should and Suppose To

You can use *supposed to* and *should* to talk about an obligation.

An obligation is something you *should* do or that other people expect you to do.

You use the verb "to be" in front of *supposed to*:

verb "to be" + *supposed to* + verb

or

You can use the modal *should* to also show obligation, duty and correctness.

Examples:

- *I'm supposed to be in class.*
- *I should head off.*
- *I'm supposed to be excited but I'm quite nervous.*

